

The Boston Globe

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Mass. native buys Celtics for \$6.1b

Chisholm's group to pay record price; Grousbeck will stay in charge through 2027-28 season



SYMPHONY TECHNOLOGY GROUP

"I'm all about winning championships and raising banners, and doing that now, and . . . over the long term," Bill Chisholm said.

By Adam Himmelsbach
GLOBE STAFF

As the Celtics were marching through the playoffs last spring en route to the franchise's 18th NBA championship, Bill Chisholm was following just as avidly as when he was a child growing up in Georgetown and Johnny Most was calling games on the radio.

Before games he would play rock music and record a hype video predicting how the Celtics

would fare, texting it to his wife, Kimberly, and their three adult children. Even at 56, he would not let his childhood passion fade.

"I watch every game or I'm at the games, and I love it," Chisholm said. "I just absolutely love it."

Co-founder of a California investment firm, Chisholm at the time never imagined he was less than a year from becoming an integral part of the storied fran-

chise.

On Thursday, the Grousbeck family agreed to sell the team to an investment group led by Chisholm at a valuation of \$6.1 billion. It is a record for a North American sports team, surpassing the \$6.05 billion Josh Harris paid for the NFL's Washington Commanders.

"I'm all about winning championships and raising banners, and doing that now, and also doing it over the long term," Chish-

olm said in an interview with the Globe on Thursday. "I think [lead governor Wyc Grousbeck] has done an incredible job of balancing that, and I think that's the path we're on and that's the path we should stay on."

The sale is pending approval by the NBA Board of Governors. Fifty-one percent of the team will be sold to Chisholm soon after approval, with the balance closing in 2028. Grousbeck is exiting the team.

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What's ahead

The team's payroll will swell in the near future and luxury taxes will skyrocket, forcing big decisions for the new owner, writes Gary Washburn. **C1.**

Changing hands

The storied franchise has had a number of owners through the years, but the current group, which bought the team in 2002, has held it the longest. **C4.**

Trump aims to ax Education Department

He orders dismantling; Congress must approve

Federal funding makes up a relatively small portion of public school budgets — roughly

13%

Standoff escalates

A federal judge told the Trump administration to explain why its failure to turn around flights carrying deportees to El Salvador did not violate his court order. **A8.**

Trump team wasn't always anti-judge

By Tal Kopan
GLOBE STAFF

WASHINGTON — President Trump has been escalating his standoff with the federal judiciary, seething at judges who have blocked and reversed his policies. On Tuesday, he called for the impeachment of one such judge for ruling against his administration.

"Each day the nation arises to see what the craziest unelected local federal judge has decided the policies of the government of the United States shall be," Trump's deputy chief of staff Stephen Miller wrote on X on Tuesday amid a storm of criticism of the judiciary. "It is madness. It is lunacy. It is pure lawlessness. It is the gravest assault on democracy. It must and will end."

But before Trump took office, many of his top lieutenants, led by Miller, had asked federal judges to make similar such rulings to block the

JUDGES, Page A8

By Mandy McLaren
GLOBE STAFF

A little more than a week after his education secretary slashed nearly half of its workforce, President Trump on Thursday signed an executive order aimed at abolishing the Department of Education, which for decades has played a vital role in ensur-

► **Parents are worried. A7.**

ing all students have equal educational opportunities.

With governors who have championed diverting public funds to private schools looking on at the White House, Trump said he intends to return oversight of education to the states — an oft-repeated piece of conservative rhetoric that experts said distorts the federal government's limited role in the nation's schools.

"This is a very popular

DOE, Page A7

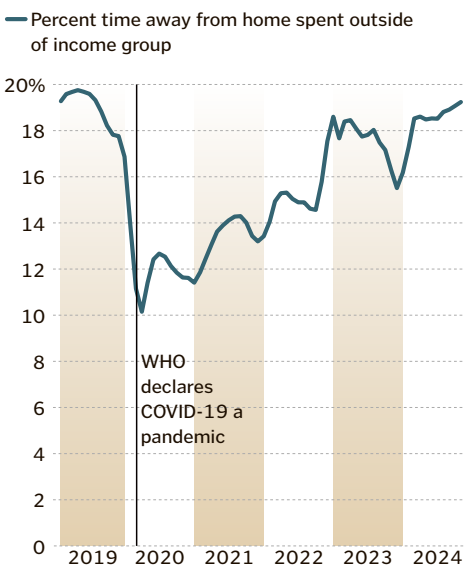


CRAIG F. WALKER/GLOBE STAFF/FILE

Dining went outdoors in 2020, but with so many workers staying home, Boston was practically dead.

Social exploration returns to pre-pandemic levels

The percentage of time individuals in Greater Boston spent outside their income level while away from home rose above 19 percent in October 2024 for the first time in over five years.



SOURCE: Northeastern University Network Science Institute. Income levels defined by the home location of an individual's census block group level, grouped into quantiles.

JOHN HANCOCK/GLOBE STAFF

Getting the heart of the city beating again

After COVID, some workers may never return. But fun — not business — may be the biggest draw.

By Janelle Nanos
GLOBE STAFF

Five years ago this week, Boston was unrecognizable. Its normally bustling streets were deserted. Its office towers and arenas empty. Its restaurants dark. The days stretched to weeks, then months, of wondering when the people would come back.

Eventually, they did. Five years after COVID shut down Boston, things feel, by and large, normal again. There are lines at lunch spots, crowds at the Garden, college kids at the bars. But the city isn't the same.

Measures of foot traffic and office vacancy haven't fully rebounded. Hybrid work remains pretty common. Car traffic is worse.

Empty storefronts persist.

But more than anything, we just don't mix like we did before.

A Northeastern University study of cell-phone data found that when COVID hit, inhabitants of Greater Boston became far less likely to interact with people of different socioeconomic backgrounds. Those numbers have been recovering, but for many parts of the region, particularly in the suburbs, levels of what researchers call "social exploration" have fallen sharply.

And that's bad news for a city whose culture and economy have, for centuries, been built on people mixing, connecting, and sharing ideas, said Northeastern University physicist Esteban Moro, who's leading the study. Bad enough that it raises questions about

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Dropping in when the secret's out

Artist who made himself a home at mall takes another look 18 years later

By Dan McGowan
GLOBE STAFF

Under a stairwell, behind a locked door, and up a steel industrial ladder in the depths of the Providence Place Mall parking garage, there's still evidence of the crime.

Shattered glass from a china hutch and concrete debris from cinder blocks hauled in by the culprits are scattered across the floor. A broken lamp is tossed aside in one corner, and there's some rope tied to a cement column along the wall.

Oh, and there's a Subway bag with napkins still inside but no sandwich to be found.

"That's not us," exclaimed Michael Townsend, referring to the fast food litter inside this 750-square-foot room that he and a group of artists transformed into a fully furnished apartment between 2003 and 2007, when Townsend was finally caught and banned from the mall for life.

Until now. Townsend is the star of "Secret Mall Apartment," a documentary about living at Providence Place Mall, is opening today across the country.



JEREMY WORKMAN

"Secret Mall Apartment," a documentary about living at Providence Place Mall, is opening today across the country.



Sprinkle away

Friday: Early rain, clearing. High 47-52. Low 35-40.
Saturday: Windy, warmer. High 58-63. Low 28-33.
Sunrise: 6:45 Sunset: 6:58
Weather and Comics, G6-7. Obituaries, C11.

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Passengers using ride apps to travel to or from Logan Airport will start paying higher fares this summer, after fees the ride-hailing companies pay were increased. **B5.**

The fascination with JFK's assassination remains strong, as the newly released documents are pored over. **A2, B1.**

Mass General Brigham residents and attending physicians picketed to support legislation aimed at capping hospital CEOs' compensation. **B4.**

Israel expanded ground operations as Hamas fired rockets at central Israel for the first time in months. **A4.**

"Snow White" is back in a live-action remake. Critic Odie Henderson has strong words. **G1.**